ABOUT

· THE PROJECT EXPLORES LEADER-MEDIA RELATIONS – MAINLY INTERACTIONS BETWEEN PRIME MINISTERS (AND THEIR COMMUNICATION AIDES) AND JOURNALISTS – IN FINLAND, LITHUANIA, POLAND AND SWEDEN.

· THE PROJECT ADDRESSES THREE SCHOLARLY AND RELATED THEMES:

1. THE 'PRESIDENTIALIZATION' OF POLITICS;
2. THE 'PERSONALIZATION' OF POLITICS;
3. THE 'MEDIATIZATION' OF POLITICS.

IT ALSO ADDRESSES THEMES WITHIN JOURNALISM STUDIES SUCH AS JOURNALISM IN DIFFERENT MEDIA SYSTEMS AND THE RELATION BETWEEN JOURNALISTS AND SOURCES.

· THE PROJECT IS INTER-DISCIPLINARY BY LINKING THE ACADEMIC DISCIPLINES OF POLITICAL SCIENCE AND JOURNALISM/MEDIA STUDIES ON THE BASIS OF OUR SHARED CONCERN WITH POLITICAL COMMUNICATION

RESEARCH PROJECT (2014-2017)

FUNDED BY ÖSTERSJÖSTIFTELSEN

SYMBIOTIC LEADER-MEDIA RELATIONS?

EXPLORING INTERACTION BETWEEN PRIME MINISTERS AND THE MEDIA IN FINLAND, LITHUANIA, POLAND AND SWEDEN

OUR STARTING HYPOTHESIS:

THE RELATIONS BETWEEN PRIME MINISTERS AND JOURNALISTS ARE MUTUALLY REINFORCING AND SYMBIOTIC RATHER THAN ADVERSARIAL, BUT THIS IS AN OPEN AND EMPIRICAL QUESTION EXPLORED IN THIS PROJECT

OUR RESEARCH METHOD:

· WE RELY ON COMPLEMENTARY FORMS OF PRIMARY MATERIAL, MAINLY INTERVIEWS

· THE PROJECT ADOPTS A COMPARATIVE RESEARCH DESIGN, WITH EMPIRICAL RESEARCH IN A CROSS-NATIONAL CONTEXT

· THERE IS VARIATION IN OUR SET OF SELECTED COUNTRIES BOTH REGARDING MEDIA SYSTEM AND POLITICAL SYSTEM

OUR TEAM

PROJECT LEADER AND COORDINATOR - PROF. KARL MAGNUS JOHANSSON (SÖDERTÖRN UNIVERSITY, SWEDEN)

PROF. GUNNAR NYGREN (SÖDERTÖRN UNIVERSITY, SWEDEN)
DR. ELENA JOHANSSON (SÖDERTÖRN UNIVERSITY, SWEDEN)
PHD-CANDIDATE MILDA CELIEŠIŪTĖ (SÖDERTÖRN UNIVERSITY, SWEDEN)
PROF. TOM MORING (HELSINKI UNIVERSITY, FINLAND)
PROF. TAPIO RAUNIO (TAMPERE UNIVERSITY, FINLAND)
PROJECT ASSISTANT RISTO NIEMIKARI (TAMPERE UNIVERSITY, FINLAND)
PROF. AUKSĖ BALČYTIENĖ (VYTAUTAS MAGNUS UNIVERSITY, KAUNAS, LITHUANIA)
PROF. BOGUSŁAWA DOBEK-OSTROWSKA (WROCŁAW UNIVERSITY, POLAND)
PHD-CANDIDATE JACEK NOŻEWSKI (WROCŁAW UNIVERSITY, POLAND)

• **Karl Magnus Johansson**

THE PRIME MINISTER AND THE MEDIA

REGARDLESS OF WHAT KIND OF POLITICAL SYSTEM THEY OPERATE IN, PRIME MINISTERS HAVE TO HANDLE THE MEDIA AND NEED TO ORGANIZE FOR MEDIA AFFAIRS. PRIME MINISTERS ARE THE NATURAL FOCI OF MEDIA ATTENTION AND OFTEN REINFORCE THIS DEVELOPMENT THEMSELVES BY CULTIVATING PERSONAL IMAGES TAILORED FOR MODERN MASS MEDIA. THIS DEVELOPMENT REQUIRES PRIME MINISTERS TO POSSESS RESOURCES FOR PURPOSES OF EFFECTIVE DAY-TO-DAY MEDIA MANAGEMENT. WHAT ARE THESE RESOURCES AND PRACTICES? WHAT ARE THE CONSEQUENCES FOR EXECUTIVES?

RESEARCH PROJECT (2014-2017)

FUNDED BY ÖSTERSJÖSTIFTELSEN

• **Milda Celiešiūtė**
PhD project

SYMBIOTIC LEADER-MEDIA RELATIONS?

EXPLORING INTERACTION BETWEEN PRIME MINISTERS AND THE MEDIA IN FINLAND, LITHUANIA, POLAND AND SWEDEN

INFORMAL RELATIONS BETWEEN JOURNALISTS AND THEIR POLITICAL SOURCES

HOW ARE BACKGROUND CONVERSATIONS USED BY JOURNALISTS AND BY THEIR SOURCES? ACCESS TO THE INFORMAL NETWORK: PROFESSIONAL ASSET OR THREAT FOR JOURNALISTIC AUTONOMY? COMPARING INFORMALITY AS A PART OF POLITICAL COMMUNICATION CULTURE IN LITHUANIA AND SWEDEN. THE STUDY IS MAINLY BASED ON QUALITATIVE INTERVIEWS AND RECONSTRUCTION INTERVIEWS WITH JOURNALISTS AND WITH THE POLITICAL SOURCES.

• **Elena Johansson**

"MEDIATIZATION" IN HYBRID MEDIA SYSTEMS

IN THE DIGITAL AGE, THE MEDIA ENVIRONMENT IS MUCH DIVERSE, FRAGMENTED, AND INTERWOVEN. MODERN MEDIA SYSTEMS BECAME SUBJECT TO HYBRIDIZATION, WHEN "OLD" MEDIA INTERACT WITH "NEW" MEDIA, WITH IMPLICATIONS FOR POLITICAL COMMUNICATION. CAN WE NOW TALK ABOUT A NEW TYPE OF RELATIONS BETWEEN JOURNALISTS AND SOURCES, SO-CALLED "MEDIATED INTERDEPENDENCY"? DOES IT MEAN THAT MEDIA LOGIC HAS SHIFTED TOWARDS 'MULTIMEDIA LOGIC'? FINALLY, DO THESE NEW HYBRID MEDIA SYSTEMS IMPLY NEW MEDIA PRACTICES?